

Make sure to include the complete path to your image. In the example here, the image has been placed in the same folder as the web page. With this change, the web page now loads as:



Classes in CSS

In this lesson we're going to take a step towards more advanced CSS by introducing the notion of classes. We will use this to build a web page like this:



A class
is just
another
way to

identify elements in your HTML and give them certain attributes. The flexibility of the class allows you to apply characteristics to multiple items in your HTML if they are identified as being a member of that class. So in short, a class selector selects HTML elements in your web page that have been identified as being that class and applies the attributes you specify to it.

No doubt you've already seen classes in HTML files you've looked at. In your CSS a class is denoted with a period followed by the name assigned to the class. You can have a class without specifying the type of HTML tag it applies to such as:

```
.myclassname{  
    attributes here  
}
```

Or you can apply it to a specific tag, such as the paragraph tag. This example will set the font color of any paragraph marked "myblueclass" to blue:

```
p.myblueclass{  
    color: blue;  
}
```

To specify that a paragraph in your html file is a member of this class,

```
<p class="myblueclass">This is a sample paragraph that uses the myblueclass CSS class.  
</p>
```

Remember that you can apply a class to multiple elements in a page. For example, we can specify that all HTML elements with class="center" are center-aligned and have blue text:

```
.center {  
    text-align: center;  
    color: blue;  
}
```

Then you can apply this to multiple elements:

```
<h1 class="center">Header with the center class</h1>
<p> A normal paragraph without special formatting</p>
<p class="center">A formatted paragraph.</p>
<p>Another normal paragraph</p>
```

This produces:

Header with the center class

A normal paragraph without special formatting

A formatted paragraph.

Another normal paragraph

So we've saved some labor. We are able to apply the same attributes (center and blue text) to different HTML elements. So lets see how to create the web page shown at the beginning of this chapter.

First lets add the flower in the upper left.

```
<style>
body{
  margin-left: 200px;
  background: #5d9ab2 url("flower.jpg") no-repeat top left;
}
```

Now lets create a class with the property of centered text. The class will be called *container*:

```
.container{
```

```
text-align: center;
}
```

The next class we create will draw the red box:

```
.my_box{
  border: 2px solid red;
  margin-left: auto;
  margin-right: auto;
  width: 80%;
  text-align: center;
  padding: 8px;
}
```

Finally we close out our `<style>` sheet setting h1 headers to white.

```
h1{
  color: white;
}
```

Now let's write the html for the page:

```
<body>
<div class="container">
  <div class="my_box">
    <h1>My Great Web Page</h1>
    <p>Some text to display. This is our most extensive example of css yet.</p>
  </div>
</div>
</body>
```